

Speaker 1 [00:00:00] Okay. Just for the sake of recording or in the recording, I'm going to ask you again, is it fine if I start recording?

Speaker 2 [00:00:07] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:00:08] All right. So, thank you for participating in this interview. As mentioned over email, we want to know more about your views, our romantic relationships, and we believe your experience and perspective will bring much to the project. So I'll ask you some demographic questions and then we'll get straight to, like, pretty much everything in terms of relationships. So how old are you?

Speaker 2 [00:00:37] I am [16-20].

Speaker 1 [00:00:39] All right. And how long have you been together?

Speaker 2 [00:00:43] For over [1-5] year.

Speaker 1 [00:00:47] And do you have children?

Speaker 2 [00:00:50] No. I do not.

Speaker 1 [00:00:52] And who lives in your household?

Speaker 2 [00:00:56] My parents and my grandparents.

Speaker 1 [00:01:01] And what is your main source of income or your current job?

Speaker 2 [00:01:08] I would say just parents and financial aid.

Speaker 1 [00:01:17] All right. How would you like me to address your partner? Girlfriend. Partner. Lover. By name?

Speaker 2 [00:01:25] Girlfriend is fine.

Speaker 1 [00:01:27] Okay. All right. So, yeah, from now on, I'll just be taking some notes and listening to you. And so to start off with, tell me about your love story.

Speaker 2 [00:01:41] Um, so it started during [year level]. When she moved in our school.

Speaker 1 [00:01:49] Mm hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:01:50] And then that was when I first started noticing her.

Speaker 1 [00:01:53] Mm hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:01:54] And then she then asked me out. Or as to get to know me better. And we started talking for over a month or so. And then I asked her out at the beach. And that's how it started.

Speaker 1 [00:02:15] Mm hmm.

Speaker 1 [00:02:19] And when you ask her out on the beach, is that where it became official or was it when she asked you out? Or she confessed, or?

Speaker 2 [00:02:30] That was when we became official.

Speaker 1 [00:02:35] On the beach, or?

Speaker 2 [00:02:36] Yes, on the beach.

Speaker 1 [00:02:46] Alright and, how would you compare the quality of your relationship with that of your friends' relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:03:01] I feel like, we communicate better.

Speaker 1 [00:03:11] Mhmm.

Speaker 2 [00:03:12] And. How? How great. I guess just like communication. I feel like we have that connection and like

Speaker 1 [00:03:23] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:03:24] Know the person and what they want and what they not want.

Speaker 1 [00:03:27] Mhm.

Speaker 2 [00:03:28] And I think that's something, that's quality for us over our friends and stuff. So I think communication.

Speaker 1 [00:03:42] Mhm.

Speaker 2 [00:03:43] And yeah, I think that's pretty much it.

Speaker 1 [00:03:45] Yeah, the key component. Yeah, definitely.

Speaker 2 [00:03:48] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:03:49] Right. And how many romantic partners have you had in the past?

Speaker 2 [00:03:55] She's my first one.

Speaker 1 [00:04:02] And how would you, okay. Yeah. My bad. Okay. Yeah. What's the first one? Okay. Yeah. So, in general, what do you think makes a relationship high quality?

Speaker 2 [00:04:18] What makes a relationship..um, I feel like communication and showing affection to the person and showing that you care and trust them.

Speaker 1 [00:04:32] Mhmm.

Speaker 2 [00:04:33] And trust them is a good high quality because it shows that you really care for them and you show that you really care for the relationship and that it's, it shows that you really love them.

Speaker 1 [00:04:49] Mhmm.

Speaker 2 [00:04:50] So I think that's a high quality relationship in my point of view.

Speaker 1 [00:04:54] Mhmm. What about low quality? What makes a relationship low quality?

Speaker 2 [00:04:59] Low quality. Someone who's, I guess, like who's always on their phone not paying attention or spending time with a partner. It is low quality for me.

Speaker 1 [00:05:20] Yeah, I definitely agree. Um. When would you say your relationship was of? The lowest quality?

Speaker 2 [00:05:44] In this relationship?

Speaker 1 [00:05:45] Yes.

Speaker 2 [00:05:51] Lowest quality. I would. Long distance relationship would be like a low quality.

Speaker 1 [00:06:07] Um, Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:06:08] I guess that would be the low quality of this relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:06:15] Mm hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:06:16] Because it could lead to some arguments sometimes. And miscommunication. And I would find it a low quality.

Speaker 1 [00:06:30] Right. Well, what do you say? It would be the highest quality?

Speaker 2 [00:06:37] Highest quality would be communication. Showing affection and taking their time to spend with a partner and not doing anything else and just spending time with them, going to the beach and stuff. And getting food would be my high quality.

Speaker 2 [00:07:04] Mm.

Speaker 1 [00:07:06] And you've mentioned some, but what are the most important things in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:07:16] First of all, I would say communication.

Speaker 1 [00:07:21] Mhmm.

Speaker 2 [00:07:22] Second, trust. And third, I guess, just like showing affection.

Speaker 1 [00:07:35] Mm hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:07:36] That would be my top three.

Speaker 1 [00:07:37] Mm hmm. And why do you, why do you say so?

Speaker 2 [00:07:42] For communication, you would understand your partner better

Speaker 1 [00:07:54] Mhmm.

Speaker 1 [00:07:55] And you would, like, like, I guess, like agree to each other.

Speaker 2 [00:08:00] Mhmm.

Speaker 1 [00:08:01] So you don't argue a lot. Second, trust just by trusting your, your other partner.

Speaker 1 [00:08:07] Mhm.

Speaker 2 [00:08:08] Um. By trusting them to, like, not do anything else and stuff. And not doing anything crazy.

Speaker 1 [00:08:21] Mhm.

Speaker 2 [00:08:22] Um. Third, showing affection. Wait, what was the third one?

Speaker 1 [00:08:24] Yeah. Affection.

Speaker 2 [00:08:25] Affection. I guess it just shows that you really care. And it shows that you really care. And you're there for them.

Speaker 1 [00:08:33] Mm hmm. Yeah. And this is a very like broad question. And feel free to take time to think, because I know it's a hard question, but for you, what is love?

Speaker 2 [00:08:58] For me, love is someone who's there to take care of you, who is always there for you. Love doesn't have to be physical. It can be emotional. Just a partner who is there, who is always listening to you, spending time, who's always taking care of you and checking up on you. And I think that's what love is to me.

Speaker 1 [00:09:32] Mm hmm. Yeah. And how important do you think love is in a relationship? Because, you know, some people get into relationships without love or, you know, they have their own reasons for being in said relationships. So how important is love in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:09:57] It is really important.

Speaker 1 [00:10:01] Mhm.

Speaker 2 [00:10:02] Love is really important in a relationship because, it, I guess it's like the feeling of someone there and someone who really cares for you, will keep you stable.

Speaker 1 [00:10:21] Mhmm.

Speaker 2 [00:10:22] I have seen it many times in my family. They're always there laughing and partying and smiling. And I guess that affected how I like, view what love looks like.

Speaker 1 [00:10:41] Mhmm. Yeah. that's wonderful. And how do you know your girlfriend loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:11:00] How do I know? I guess when like I'm feeling down and when I show like, no emotion at all, she checks up on me.

Speaker 1 [00:11:17] Mhmm.

Speaker 2 [00:11:18] And I guess like from the long distance relationship, she would go home and, the reason why she would go home is because of me.

Speaker 1 [00:11:29] Mhmm.

Speaker 2 [00:11:30] And that's how I know that she really loves me.

Speaker 1 [00:11:46] Mhm. Yeah, like you said, that you guys are long distance. Like how much of a distance is it? Is it like a whole different city or? Like just,

Speaker 2 [00:12:00] A city. Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:12:02] City? Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:12:03] About 50 miles, I believe.

Speaker 1 [00:12:06] Fifty miles. Okay. Now. You mentioned some, but what are some other challenges you face in the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:12:20] First, it was long distance.

Speaker 1 [00:12:23] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:12:31] I guess sometimes communication because so I could be saying something like as a joke, but she would find it really offensive.

Speaker 1 [00:12:42] Mhmm.

Speaker 2 [00:12:43] And like, that would be like miscommunication, I guess. Would be like one of the challenge. But throughout, like the argument at the end of the day, we talk about it.

Speaker 1 [00:12:53] Mhmm.

Speaker 2 [00:12:54] And show what the problem was and just, just go through it and talk about it.

Speaker 1 [00:13:02] Mhm. And how do you guys talk about it? You know, there's different ways to, I guess, resolve the miscommunication, right?

Speaker 2 [00:13:14] First, I would like both of us would say like how like how we are feeling.

Speaker 1 [00:13:21] Mhm.

Speaker 2 [00:13:22] And like show how you really feel and then talk about the problem and like what we can do better the next time so it doesn't happen again.

Speaker 1 [00:13:34] Mhm.

Speaker 2 [00:13:35] And that's how we talk about it.

Speaker 1 [00:13:43] Well, then. And how often would you say that these like, I guess, you can say fights occur?

Speaker 2 [00:13:58] I would say like, about like 3 to 4. I probably say like once a week or so.

Speaker 1 [00:14:18] Mhm. And just like to put it into a specific topic. What are these fights mainly about?

Speaker 2 [00:14:33] I guess like agreements.

Speaker 1 [00:14:36] Mhmm.

Speaker 2 [00:14:37] Would be one. And just like saying this is like joking around and the other person would just like find it offensive. And third, I don't really know. I guess, like sometimes, she would feel like I don't love her and that I don't show that I care.

Speaker 1 [00:15:05] Mhmm.

Speaker 2 [00:15:06] Would be one too. And I think those are the main three that we mostly argue about.

Speaker 1 [00:15:15] Mhmm. All right. And in that moment when she feels like she's not being loved, that you don't care. I guess it goes along with how you resolve the issue. But how do you, how do you make her feel? And how do you show that you care?

Speaker 2 [00:15:42] Well, we're both petty, so sometimes I just stay quiet for, like, a couple of hours.

Speaker 1 [00:15:49] Uh huh.

Speaker 2 [00:15:50] But after that, I would like, tell her how she feels and then she would be startled about it. And I would keep telling how she feels and that what's wrong and show her that I am there listening to her and my full attention to her.

Speaker 1 [00:16:09] Mm hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:16:11] And then sometimes when she would go home and then before the fight or argument, before the week, I would get her flowers.

Speaker 1 [00:16:22] Mm hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:16:23] And show that I'm really there and I really care for her and love her.

Speaker 1 [00:16:29] Oh, that's so cute. Okay. And. Yeah. Besides those main three like communication, giving her flowers, and pretty much like resolving issues. What are other ways that you maintain your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:16:57] Once in a while we would check up on each other.

Speaker 1 [00:17:00] Mm hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:17:01] Like how we really feel. Second, we would just hang out, go for like a beach, beach walk. Food runs and do, like, activities together. And when we're long distance, we would face time each other and do homework together and play games.

Speaker 1 [00:17:39] Mhmm. Yeah. You said that you guys, like, check up on each other. How often does that usually happen? Cause you say once in a while, but like, specifically arrange?

Speaker 2 [00:17:51] I would probably say, once a month.

Speaker 1 [00:17:58] Mhm.

Speaker 2 [00:18:00] Yeah. Once a month.

Speaker 1 [00:18:04] Yeah, in general, would you say that the relationship is good for you?

Speaker 2 [00:18:10] Yes, I believe so.

Speaker 1 [00:18:13] And, why?

Speaker 2 [00:18:16] Just someone who's out there. Shit. It shows that someone really actually cares for me.

Speaker 1 [00:18:24] Mhmm.

Speaker 2 [00:18:25] And can go to college, I really have no friends. Just making new friends is hard for me because I'm very anti-social.

Speaker 1 [00:18:35] Mhmm.

Speaker 2 [00:18:36] I guess just a partner that's there listening to you and someone there who actually cares for you and spend time together.

Speaker 1 [00:18:44] Mhmm.

Speaker 2 [00:18:45] Is what's – the best that happened.

Speaker 1 [00:18:52] Mhm. Love that. That's, love that for you. All right. And would you say that the relationship changed you?

Speaker 2 [00:19:12] I don't think it has changed me from, I guess, like friends perspective or family.

Speaker 1 [00:19:20] Mhmm.

Speaker 2 [00:19:21] Because I would still do the same thing with them and do things the same thing as I did before. I don't think it has changed me.

Speaker 1 [00:19:33] Okay. And do you think, I guess, with, with your girlfriend. Do you think she changed during the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:19:49] I don't think she did because she would also do the same thing with her family and friends.

Speaker 1 [00:19:55] Mhmm.

Speaker 2 [00:19:56] But, yeah. I don't think she has, too.

Speaker 1 [00:20:06] Mhmm. Cool. And I guess this is a very similar question, but is the person you were before the relationship the same as a person you are now?

Speaker 2 [00:20:22] I don't think so. No. Before this relationship, I was very shy.

Speaker 1 [00:20:32] Mhmm.

Speaker 2 [00:20:33] And didn't really like talking to people. But after the relationship, she would like motivate me to talk to people and make new friends and stuff and do things with them, like play games, play a sport. And she was the one that motivated me to talk to people.

Speaker 1 [00:20:55] Mhmm.

Speaker 1 [00:20:56] So I guess she has changed me from before.

Speaker 1 [00:21:05] Mm. All right. And what about your girlfriend? Do you think she's the same person that she was before the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:21:17] I do not think so. Because before she, it was very hard for her to show emotion and that she believed that love wasn't real.

Speaker 1 [00:21:35] Mhmm.

Speaker 2 [00:21:36] And then I showed her how love really looked like or how it felt for her, just being there for her. And that changed her perspective on how love looks like. And I guess I changed the way she viewed things differently.

Speaker 1 [00:21:58] Mhmm.

Speaker 2 [00:21:59] And yeah, I think she has changed or I have changed her. Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:22:07] Great. And in general, do you feel safe in the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:22:15] Yes, I do.

Speaker 1 [00:22:16] And why do you say so?

Speaker 2 [00:22:19] Um. She's always there and I always feel like it's home for me when I'm with her.

Speaker 1 [00:22:28] Mhmm.

Speaker 2 [00:22:29] And I feel comfortable sharing what I feel and how I feel with her and talking about everything about in life.

Speaker 1 [00:22:36] Mhmm.

Speaker 2 [00:22:37] And what goes through. And she's the one that I trust the most.

Speaker 1 [00:22:45] Mhm.

Speaker 2 [00:22:46] And just saying how I feel is really important because nowadays, it's really hard to show your emotions to other people because I would think that they would judge me for that,

Speaker 1 [00:23:00] Mhm.

Speaker 2 [00:23:01] But she wouldn't. So I really feel safe.

Speaker 1 [00:23:07] Yeah. All right. So for these next questions, I'm going to share my screen. All right. So yeah. So these are likert scales and I'll kind of read you the statement and then you rate it what you think is appropriate. So for the first one, my partner usually really listens to me.

Speaker 2 [00:23:54] Um, I would say, a nine.

Speaker 1 [00:23:56] A nine. Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:24:00] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:24:01] And just so you know, I'm taking notes on the side.

Speaker 2 [00:24:05] Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:24:06] Nine. And why not an eight?

Speaker 2 [00:24:13] Wait, can you please repeat that?

Speaker 1 [00:24:15] Yeah. So you chose a nine, right?

Speaker 2 [00:24:16] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:24:17] I guess, I can ask you first, why did you choose a nine and not an eight?

Speaker 2 [00:24:21] Oh, I chose a nine because when I have, like, any problem, she would stop what she's doing and she would listen to me on what I have to say. And she has her full attention to me.

Speaker 1 [00:24:35] Mm hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:24:36] That's why I chose a nine and not an eight.

Speaker 1 [00:24:39] Mm hmm. Okay. All right. Next one. Oops. Wait, yeah. My partner is usually responsive to my needs.

Speaker 2 [00:25:00] I would say an eight. Because our schedules are very different. So I wouldn't. like, can't really like, like, communicate with her when I have my class and she doesn't have a class? I guess, just like time management would be the problem. That's why I chose eight and not a nine.

Speaker 1 [00:25:25] Mhm.

Speaker 2 [00:25:26] But she's always there for me and, and like taking care of stuff.

Speaker 1 [00:25:35] Mhm. All right. Next question. How satisfied are you with your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:25:42] I am completely satisfied because she, it shows that she really cares and she's always there listening for me or to me. And she, shows that, shows affection.

Speaker 1 [00:26:02] Mhm.

Speaker 2 [00:26:03] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:26:04] Cool. And that's. Yeah. Okay, I'll stop sharing my screen and then continue with just these last couple of questions. Okay. Mhmm. All right. So I have two questions here. I hope you don't mind me asking. But, feel free to say if it's too sensitive for you to share. But I wanted to know more about your physical intimacy as a couple. Would you like to continue?

Speaker 2 [00:26:56] No.

Speaker 1 [00:26:58] Okay. All right. So for one. Or. Yeah. So just one more question. Did the relationship fulfill your expectations?

Speaker 2 [00:27:20] No, it did not. I wasn't expecting how love really looks like. It had a different view on the relationship for me. Just because, just a person there being for you or them being there for you is all that matters for me and showing that they really care. And that was a different view from me because love, I viewed it as, I guess, in like a sexual way. But I had that, now that changed and it fulfilled to how I view it.

Speaker 1 [00:28:16] Mm hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:28:17] And. Yes, it did.

Speaker 1 [00:28:18] All right. All right. So we're close to wrapping up. And I'm pretty much just going to summarize what we talked about. Again, there's specific details here, but I'm just summarizing it. All right. So you're [16-20]. You've been together over [1-5] year. No children. You live with your parents and grandparents. And in terms of your love story, you guys met [year level]. That's when she moved to your school. She asked you

out and, and then when you, and then you eventually asked her out officially on the beach. Um. Comparing that of the quality of your friends' relationship and that of yours, you think that you communicate better because you know what you each other want and don't want to like that quality aspect of it. And then, you said this is your first relationship. For what makes a relationship high quality, you said communication, trust, and affection, where you care for them and the relationship and it shows that you love them and you show that you love them. For low quality is someone who's like on their phone all the time and not spending time with their partner. Um. Uh, and for, like, your, your relationship, low quality would. Um, one variable, I guess you can say, is the long distance. Um, because it causes miscommunication and arguments. And then high quality is definitely the presence of communication, affection, taking time with your partner or your girlfriend and like going to the beach, spending time together, getting food. For the most important things in a relationship, you said communication, trust and affection. For your definition of what is love, you said that it's someone who takes care of you and is always there for you. Not just physically, but also emotionally and someone who listens to you. Um, you said that love is very important because, because that's when you feel that someone is there for you and they care for you and you kind of echoed with that, with your like the love that you see from your own family.

Speaker 2 [00:31:24] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:31:24] And you know that your girlfriend loves you because when you're feeling down and you're kind of like not expressing your feelings, she goes out of her way to talk to you about it and visit you. Um. Some challenges are like definitely the long distance, also communication. There's like jokes, but sometimes one of, one of you guys find it offensive and you, to resolve it, you talk about how you're feeling, the problem itself, to prevent it from the future. And these disagreements or fights happen around once a week. Other ways that you maintain your relationship is having a monthly checkup, also hanging out with each other, going to the beach, food runs and activities. And when you guys are long distance, you face time, do homework together, and play games. And you said that the relationship is good for you because in general, there's someone that cares for you. You gave that example of like in college that you don't really have friends. And so that relationship, it means a lot to you. And you said that the relationship didn't really change you from your friends and family's perspective. Same with your girlfriend. Though like a quality that has change is, that, or a component that has change is that you're very shy. And after the relationship, she encourages you to go out of your comfort zone and talk to people. So that's a change. And then you said no for her as well. But a component is also there. It was hard for her to show love, but after that communication, it's easier for her to do so now. And you definitely feel safe in the relationship. You feel comfortable sharing everything in life and you trust her the most. And that's because she doesn't judge you. I'll look in my notes for the likert scale. For the question, "my partner usually really listens to me," you said a nine because she would stop whatever she's doing and give you her full attention. For "my partner is usually responsive to my needs," you said an eight because due to school schedules and time management. But when she can be, she's definitely responsive to your needs. And for, like the general question about being satisfied, you're completely satisfied because she shows that she cares and always listens to you and shows affection. Yeah, that's mainly the summaries or anything else you'd like to add?

Speaker 2 [00:35:04] No, that's good.

Speaker 1 [00:35:06] Okay, great. All right. So thank you so much. Now, before we end, I want to talk to you about how we handle the data. So as a research project, we want to be

as ethically transparent as possible. And so I wanted to know which data sharing option you're most comfortable with. So there are two options. The first option is that the transcript portions can be shared, none of which can be identified to you. So the de-identified transcript can also be read by other researchers. Or, if you were bolder like another option would be, the whole transcript can be shared with the removal of sensitive and overly identifying details so it would be anonymized. Although in this in this option, there is a very, very minimal chance that someone who knows you well, can like piece together the details in the transcript and narrowed down like among their colleagues they believe it is, although again, no sensitive information will be shared. So of the two options, which are you most comfortable with?

Speaker 2 [00:36:19] I would say the second one.

Speaker 1 [00:36:21] Okay. All right. So thank you so much again for participating in the study. I would like to let you know that this is also being done in the Philippines, Brazil, Netherlands, France, and all over the US. So for this study to be successful, there is also one more thing I would like to ask you if that's okay with you.

Speaker 2 [00:36:44] That's fine.

Speaker 1 [00:36:45] All right. So can you recommend to close people in your life as a nominator? We would ask them for additional couples that might be interested in this study. So those couples are ones that you wouldn't know of or interact with. So in this way, we can get as diverse of a network we can get. Is that okay with you?

Speaker 2 [00:37:11] That's okay.

Speaker 1 [00:37:12] All right. So I do have these criteria that I sent. Give me one sec. All right. And let me know if, like, anyone rings the bell for these. So, um, a heterosexual couple who have been together [1-5] to [6-10] years, I think. The criteria, specific procedure that comes to mind is they have to be [16-20] and older and they have to be U.S. citizens or they came to the US before the age of five. And then for the other ones, it's again, a heterosexual couple, but who have been together 10 to 20 years with high satisfaction or again, heterosexual couple who have been together 20 plus years, but with low satisfaction, or an LGBT couple who have been together for any length with low satisfaction. Do any of these ring a bell?

Speaker 2 [00:38:17] No.

Speaker 1 [00:38:19] Okay. That's completely fine. All right. So, yeah, that's pretty much it. Do you have any questions?

Speaker 2 [00:38:28] No, I do not.

Speaker 1 [00:38:29] All right. Yeah. So thank you so much. And if you want, I could, like, put down your information and not specifically yours if you don't want to. But for when the study does come out, for all the results and stuff, if you're really interested, you could tell, you know, Natalie if she wants, like if she's curious, she could just email me back and I'll forward that email to my professor. But other than that, that's pretty much it. And thank you so much for your time.

Speaker 2 [00:39:08] Okay, thank you.

Speaker 1 [00:39:09] Thank you. Bye.

Speaker 2 [00:39:11] Bye, bye.